

CSA BER-BRA Network Explorer

Quick Start Guide

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The **CSA BER-BRA Network Explorer** is an interactive tool for exploring documented relationships between Community Supported Agriculture (CSA) and related actors across Berlin-Brandenburg.

It was developed by me as part of the [Berlin University Alliance's X-Student Research Project](#) initiative "How can a box of vegetables weave places together? Rural-Urban food networks in the Berlin-Brandenburg area."

If you would like to learn more about the project, discuss the methodology, collaborate, or suggest features, please [contact me via LinkedIn](#) (preferred) or at charlietellingham@gmail.com.

The network represents relationships identified and documented during the research process. It should therefore be understood as a representation of the documented network rather than a complete census of all CSA relationships in Berlin-Brandenburg. See the project's [GitHub page](#) for further information about data collection, network construction and analysis.

The Explorer is a static web application. Network data is loaded from [CSV files stored with the project](#), and the application does not currently use a database or backend service.

Acknowledgements

This project was developed as part of the Berlin University Alliance **X-Student Research Group**, "*How can a box of vegetables weave places together? Rural-Urban food networks in the Berlin-Brandenburg area.*"

I would like to thank **Federica Ammaturo** for leading the research group and for her guidance and support throughout the project, and **Chen Gao** for his support and contributions to the research process.

I am also grateful to the **Berlin University Alliance** for providing the opportunity to participate in collaborative research and develop this project within an interdisciplinary research environment.

Finally, thank you to the **other students in the X-Student Research Group** for their ideas, discussions, feedback and contributions to the wider project. The network explorer builds on the collective research and knowledge developed through the group.

Using the Explorer

Selecting Actors

- **Click** an actor to highlight it and its immediate connections.
- **Shift + Click** additional actors to expand the current selection.
- **Shift + Click** a selected actor again to remove it from the selection.
- **Click on empty space** to clear all selections.

NOTE: Actors can also be dragged to a new location on the canvas without breaking any connections.

Hiding Actors

- **Ctrl + Click** (Windows/Linux) or **⌘ Command + Click** (Mac) on an actor to temporarily hide it from the network.
 - Hidden actors can be restored at any time by clicking the **Reset Hidden Nodes** button.
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Filters

Use the left sidebar to:

- Filter by **Actor Type**
 - Filter by **Relationship Type**
 - **Select All** or **Clear All** for each filter group.
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Display

The **Display** panel currently includes:

- **Show Names** to toggle actor names on or off.
- **Curved Connections** to toggle curved relationship lines on or off.

Note: When curved relationship lines are enabled, multiple (limited to two for now) relationships between the same two actors can be displayed simultaneously (for example, both a financial and an educational relationship). When curved lines are disabled, only a single line is shown between two actors, possibly hiding other existing relationship types

between those actors. All relationships can still be explored by filtering relationship types using the Relationship Type filters.

Actor Information

Selecting an actor displays:

- Actor name
 - Actor type
 - Role
 - Number of connections
 - A complete, scrollable list of connected actors
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Current Limitations

The CSA BER-BRA Network Explorer is an evolving prototype and currently has several limitations:

- No search functionality for actors.
- No directed relationships. All relationships (directed and undirected) are currently displayed as undirected.
- No integrated network statistics (e.g. Degree, Betweenness, Eigenvector, or PageRank).
- No community detection or community-based colouring.
- No node sizing based on network metrics.
- No detailed relationship information when selecting an edge.
- No export of filtered networks or images.
- No ability to save or reload network views.
- No geographic filtering or map integration.
- Limited actor profiles (e.g. websites, contact information, and supporting evidence are not yet included).
- No timeline or temporal analysis of network changes.
- No in-app editing of actors or relationships; updates must be made directly to the source data files.
- Collaborative editing and cloud synchronisation are not currently supported.

The explorer may be updated with additional features and expanded network data as the project develops.

Please contact me for further information, collaboration, or feature ideas.